# Suspicious instructions in shared files

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## Monthly awareness bulletin

A shared document, support message or search result may contain instructions that are unrelated to the task at hand. Recent examples include text that asks a reader to redirect a payment, disclose an access code or disregard an established procedure.

## Example wording

One warning sign is a phrase such as "ignore previous instructions" followed by a request to send information to a new destination. An urgent tone or an internal-looking heading does not establish who wrote the message.

## What employees should do

Verify a requested process change through an established contact rather than contact details embedded in the suspicious message. Use New ticket at /tickets/new/ to request help, and retain the original message and the time it was received for reference.

## Handling a suspected disclosure

If you already entered a password or verification code at an unexpected destination, contact the IT Service Desk promptly and describe what happened. Do not forward the credential in your report.